released all European prisoners-of-war. Mindon Min sued for peace but refused to sign a treaty ceding Burmese territory.

THE THIRD ANGLO-BURMESE WAR

The third Anglo-Burmese war was the third and last of the three wars fought between the British and the Burmese. The war ended the Konbaung dynasty in Upper Burma and saw the loss of Burma's sovereignty as Burma became part of the British Raj, a province of British India. The annexation of Upper Burma had much to do with the pressure exerted by British and other commercial interests in Rangoon.

Britain and Burma severed diplomatic relations following a succession of crises in 1879 that saw the withdrawal of British resident in Burma after the British accused the Burmese of infringing on articles of the 1862 and 1867 treaties. When the British became aware of Burmese plans with the French to purchase military equipment in May 1883, relations between Britain and Burma deteriorated further. A fine imposed on the Bombay Burmah Trading Company by a Burmese court served to trigger events that led to the British issuing an ultimatum on October 22, 1885, demanding that Burma accept a new British resident, and also included the suspension of legal action and/or fines imposed on the Bombay Burmah Trading Company, the relinquishing of Burmese sovereignty of international relations, and the development of trade facilities in Upper Burma. Thibaw Min refused the terms on November 9, 1885, setting the stage for brief war with Britain.

In a period of two weeks between November 14, 1885, and November 27, 1885, a force of 11,000 led by Major General Harry North Dalrymple Prendergast attacked and defeated Burmese forces at Nyaung-U, Pakokku, and Myingyan, and then quickly reached Mandalay with little opposition. On October 22, 1885, British troops advanced to the Mandalay palace and demanded the unconditional surrender of Thibaw Min. On November 23, 1885, envoys of Thibaw Min offered the British terms of surrender. Thibaw Min's rule formally ended on November 29, 1885, when he abdicated the throne. Following the abdication of his throne Thibaw, his wife Supayalat, and their two daughters were exiled to Ratnagiri, India, where they lived in an official residence provided by the Indian government.